Search by name, maker or year

All | Keys | Analog synths | Digital and sampling | Arturia's own

By group | Oldest first

36 instruments

Keys

Pianos, electric pianos, organs and tape or string keyboards.

c. 1700 — **Piano V**
Acoustic grand and upright pianos · Bartolomeo Cristofori, Florence

1954 — **Wurli V**
Wurlitzer electric piano (200 series) · Wurlitzer

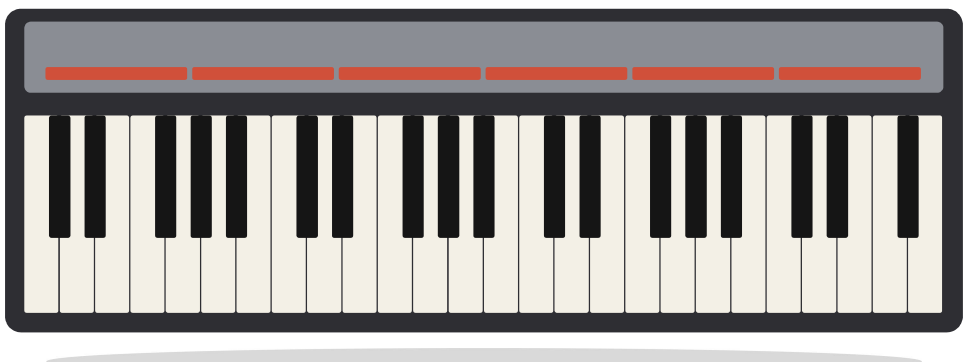


Illustration of the original, not a photograph.

Wurlitzer, a company best known for jukeboxes and theatre organs, began selling electric pianos in 1954, building on ideas by Benjamin Miessner, who had experimented with electrified pianos in the 1930s. The first models were sold as compact teaching pianos for classrooms and were built to be cheap and tough. The design was refined through the 1960s, and from 1968 the 200 series brought a more modern look. The 200A of 1974 is the version most people picture.

Each key hits a small steel reed, and its vibration is picked up electrostatically. Played softly, a Wurlitzer sounds mellow and woody. Played hard, it barks and distorts, and that character is the whole appeal. You can hear it on records from Ray Charles's What'd I Say to Supertramp's Dreamer.

> 64 keys (200 series) · steel reeds struck by hammers

Search for photos of the original

1954

B-3 V

Hammond B-3 organ · Hammond Organ Company

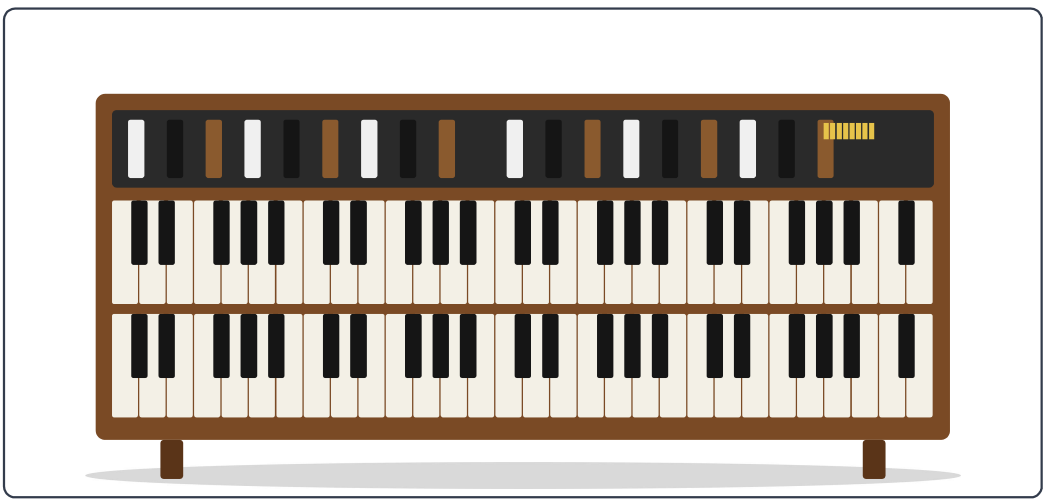


Illustration of the original, not a photograph.

Laurens Hammond built his first tonewheel organ in Chicago in 1935. It made sound electrically by spinning metal tonewheels in front of pickups rather than blowing air through pipes, which made it small and cheap enough for homes and churches. The B-3, introduced in 1954, is the version that became legend: two 61-note

keyboards, a pedalboard, nine drawbars per manual for mixing harmonics, plus percussion and vibrato. Don Leslie's rotating speaker cabinet, developed in the 1940s, added the characteristic swirl.

Drawbars let a player build a sound by ear, from a pure flute to a full, growling roar, and switching the Leslie between slow and fast is one of the most recognisable gestures in music. After jazz players adopted it, the B-3 became central to gospel, soul, blues and rock.

> Two 61-note manuals · nine drawbars per manual · tonewheel generator

Jimmy Smith made it a lead jazz instrument in the 1950s.

Search for photos of the original

1962 Vox Continental V

Vox Continental · Jennings Musical Industries, England

1963 Mellotron V

Mellotron · Streetly Electronics, Birmingham

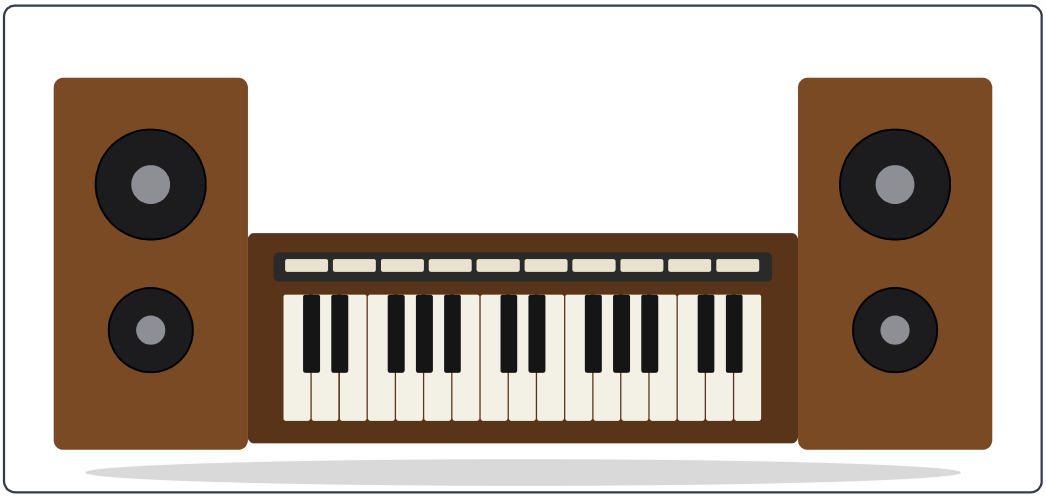


Illustration of the original, not a photograph.

The Mellotron's ancestor was the Chamberlin, built in California by Harry Chamberlin from the 1940s: a keyboard where each key played back a length of recorded tape. English brothers Bill, Frank and Norman Bradley of Streetly Electronics in Birmingham developed the idea into the Mellotron, and the first models appeared in 1963. Each key holds a tape strip of a real instrument, such as flute, cello or a choir, recorded note by note, and the tape is

pulled back by a spring on release. The M400 of 1970 became the portable workhorse.

The eerie, slightly wobbly tone comes from the tape mechanism. Notes run out after about eight seconds, so players learn to work in phrases. The Beatles put a Mellotron flute at the start of Strawberry Fields Forever, and the instrument became a signature of King Crimson, Genesis and other progressive rock bands.

> 35 keys (M400) · one tape strip per key

The Beatles used it on Strawberry Fields Forever.

Search for photos of the original

1964 **Clavinet V**
Hohner Clavinet · Hohner

1960s **Farfisa V**
Farfisa combo organs · Farfisa, Italy

1970 **Stage-73 V**
Fender Rhodes Stage 73 · Harold Rhodes / Fender

1974 **Solina V**
Solina String Ensemble · Eminent, Netherlands / ARP

1976 **CP-70 V**
Yamaha CP-70 electric grand · Yamaha

Analog synths

Monosynths, polysynths, modulars, a bass machine and a vocoder.

1939 **Vocoder V**
Bell Labs vocoder and later music vocoders · Homer Dudley, Bell Labs

1964 **Modular V**
Moog modular synthesizer · R.A. Moog Co., New York

1970 **Mini V**
Minimoog Model D · Moog Music

1971 **ARP 2600 V**
ARP 2600 · ARP Instruments, Massachusetts

1972 **Synthi V**
EMS Synthi AKS · Electronic Music Studios, London

1973 **Buchla Easel V**
Buchla Music Easel · Buchla and Associates, California

1974 **SEM V**
Oberheim SEM · Tom Oberheim, California

1977 **CS-80 V**
Yamaha CS-80 · Yamaha

1978 **Prophet-5 V**
Sequential Circuits Prophet-5 · Sequential Circuits, California

1978 **MS-20 V**
Korg MS-20 · Korg, Japan

1980 **OB-Xa V**
Oberheim OB-Xa · Oberheim, California

1981 **Jup-8 V**
Roland Jupiter-8 · Roland, Japan

1981 **Acid V**
Roland TB-303 · Roland, Japan

1982 **Jun-6 V**
Roland Juno-6 · Roland, Japan

1985 Matrix-12 V
Oberheim Matrix-12 · Oberheim, California

Digital and sampling

FM, phase distortion, wavetable and sampling instruments.

1977 Synclavier V
New England Digital Synclavier · New England Digital, Vermont

1979 CMI V
Fairlight CMI · Fairlight, Australia

1983 DX7 V
Yamaha DX7 · Yamaha

1984 CZ V
Casio CZ-101 · Casio, Japan

1984 Emulator II V
E-mu Emulator II · E-mu Systems, California

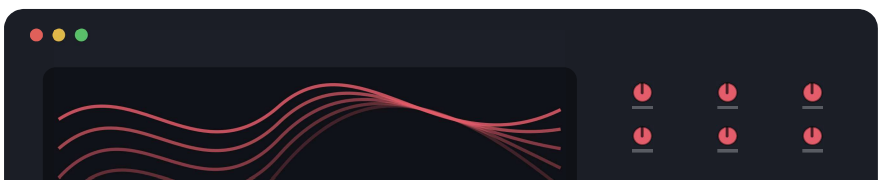
1986 Prophet-VS V
Sequential Prophet VS · Sequential Circuits, California

1987 SQ80 V
Ensoniq SQ-80 · Ensoniq, Pennsylvania

Arturia's own

Instruments that started with Arturia rather than a vintage original.

2017 Pigments
Arturia Pigments (no hardware original) · Arturia



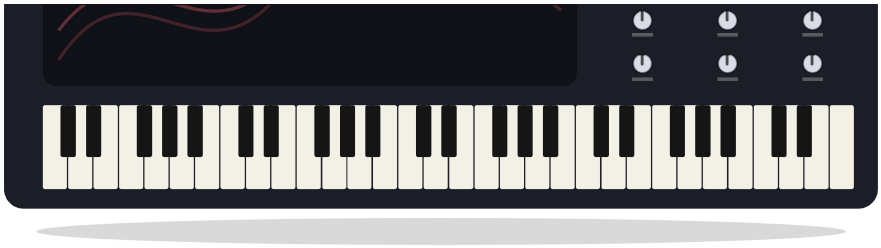


Illustration of the original, not a photograph.

Arturia was founded in Grenoble, France, in 1999 by Frédéric Brun and Gilles Pommereuil, and its early fame came from recreating vintage synths in software. Pigments, launched in 2017, took a different route. It is a synth designed from scratch, combining virtual analog and wavetable engines, a sample engine and a deep modulation system that draws its connections visually. New engines, effects and sequencers have been added through regular updates.

Pigments is known for its colourful interface and wide sound range, from clean pads to noisy, evolving textures. It is a good example of Arturia moving from recreating the past to designing new instruments.

Search for photos of the original

2022	**MiniFreak V** Arturia MiniFreak · Arturia	⌄
New	**Pure Lofi** No hardware original · Arturia	⌄
n/a	**Analog Lab** Preset browser (no hardware original) · Arturia	⌄